

Stuart McNeil

BA, PGCASR, FHEA, MBCS, MIEEE

Head of Department — Software Engineering

Cardiff School of Technologies, Cardiff Metropolitan University



✉ smcneil@cardiffmet.ac.uk ☎ 02920 417176

🔗 [cardiffmet.ac.uk](https://www.cardiffmet.ac.uk/staff/stuart-mcneil/) (<https://www.cardiffmet.ac.uk/staff/stuart-mcneil/>)

📍 Llandaff, Cardiff, CF5 2YB

FRSA

BCS HCI GROUP

ACM SIG

IEEE

SFHEA IN PROGRESS

25+

YEARS TEACHING

23

YEARS IN INDUSTRY

3

MAJOR AWARDS

32+

VALIDATION PANELS

Overview

Three decades spanning studio practice and higher education — from BAFTA-winning interactive media for the BBC, BT and the European Commission, to writing degree programmes and examining them across Europe, North Africa, the Gulf and South-East Asia; a founding member and vice chair of the arts charity Pedestrian; and, having led a department where robotics, cyber security and interaction design sit side by side, now leading Software Engineering and sitting on the management team for the Cardiff School of Technologies.

Stuart McNeil is Head of Department for Software Engineering at Cardiff Metropolitan University, supporting a team of academics whose disciplines run from electronics engineering and robotics to human–computer interaction, cyber security and information systems, and leading the pedagogic development of the department's undergraduate and postgraduate awards. His doctorate, begun in 2020, is due for submission in September 2026.

He has taught on computing and design-led modules for over twenty years, focused on interaction design and software engineering management, and has led the development of numerous programmes at both undergraduate and postgraduate level. He has held External Examiner and Moderator roles at universities in the UK, Oman, Egypt and Spain, giving him a global perspective on computing and design education.

Before academia — and alongside it, through his own studio Deft Design — he worked in the interactive media sector, winning a BAFTA for Best New Media and developing creative solutions for international organisations and leading UK companies including the European Commission, the Foreign Office, the Intellectual Property Office, BT and the BBC. That real-world experience ignited a drive to attain the highest standards in design practice. He was also a founding member and vice chair of the arts charity Pedestrian, serving on its board across thirteen years.

2025 – 2026

Head of Department, Software Engineering

Cardiff School of Technologies, Cardiff Metropolitan University

Supports a team of academics spanning electronics engineering, robotics, human–computer interaction, cyber security and information systems, and leads the pedagogic development of the department's undergraduate and postgraduate awards. Part of the management team for the Cardiff School of Technologies.

2019 – 2025

Head of Department, Applied Computing & Engineering

Cardiff School of Technologies, Cardiff Metropolitan University

2019

Programme Director — Computing for Interaction BSc (Hons) & Computing with Creative Design BSc (Hons)

Cardiff School of Technologies

2012 – 2019

Senior Lecturer & Year Tutor

Cardiff School of Management

Level 5 year tutor 2014–2019 and 2012–13; Level 4 year tutor 2013–14. BSc Software Engineering, BSc Computing and BSc Business Information Systems.

2011 – 2012

Programme Director, Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)

Cardiff School of Management

2010 – 2012

Programme Director, BSc/HNC Computing & Information Systems (part-time)

Cardiff School of Management

Also Lead Academic for the MBA by Distance Learning, 2010–2012.

2009 – 2010

Head of Department, Creative Communications

Cardiff School of Art & Design

BA (Hons) Illustration · BA/BSc (Hons) Mobile, Web & Game Design · BA (Hons) Graphic Communication · BA (Hons) Music Production & Technology · BA (Hons) Media Studies with Visual Cultures · BA (Hons) Broadcast Media.

2008 – 2010

Programme Director, Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) & Top-up

Cardiff School of Art & Design

2005 – 2010

Senior Lecturer

Cardiff School of Art & Design

Interaction design and new media teaching across Design for Interactive Media, Mobile, Web & Game Design, Graphic Communication and Fine Art.

2004 – 2007

Programme Director, Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) & Top-up

Cardiff School of Business

Wrote the three-year degree up from the Top-up award, with extensive subsequent modification to keep the programme effective and current.

2001 – 2005

Lecturer, Computing

UWIC, Cardiff School of Business

Business Information Systems and Design for Interactive Media at HNC, HND, BSc and MSc level.

Departmental leadership

Leading multi-disciplinary departments

Applied Computing & Engineering · Creative Communications

Applied Computing & Engineering spans electrical and electronic engineering, robotics engineering, data security, computer security, computing with creative design, software engineering and business information systems. Creative Communications spanned illustration, mobile, web and game design, graphic communication, music production and technology, media studies with visual cultures, and broadcast media.

Curriculum & quality

Curriculum design, validation and quality assurance

Field Group Chair · Programme Director · Head of Department

Overseen and contributed to curriculum design for 10+ awards and led the design of three awards through to validation. As Field Group Chair, supported quality assurance across 60+ modules in the Cardiff School of Technologies. Reviewed departmental curriculum design and structures with the school management team, and led revalidation, staff training for implementation, and Registry/ASQ compliance.

Programme scale

Large-scale programme leadership

MBA by Distance Learning

Academic Lead for an award running six intakes a year with a tutor base of more than twenty.

People

Staff development, mentoring and performance

Head of Department · Academic Lead

Open-door, responsive and compassionate leadership: mentoring new staff, fair and collaborative workload allocation, appraisal and performance management. Has supported staff from probation through to Principal Lecturer and Reader, and students from undergraduate through to Associate Tutor.

Research & enterprise

Building research and enterprise capacity

Knowledge transfer · Strategic Insight

Supported the formation of research groups within a department, led staff training and collaborative development, and stimulated KTP and SIP growth. Participant in a Strategic Insight Programme in the business school, a KTP, and a reverse SIP in Cardiff School of Art & Design.

Governance

Committees, chairing and institutional representation

School Management & Planning Team

Active member of SMPT with experience of chairing school committee meetings. Committee service has included the Collaborative Provision Committee, E-Learning Process Management Group, Wireless Network Committee and Learning & Teaching Committee. Has represented the school at national events and acted as an ambassador for CSAD, CSM and CST.

Mediation

Mediation and arbitration

School and corporate policy

Responsibility for mediating student and staff issues, representing the school, and cross-school arbiter work. Experience of setting and evaluating risk assessments and operating policy on equality and diversity, health and safety, quality standards and continuous performance improvement.

Languages

Welsh

Remedial and improving

Has successfully managed an all-Welsh software development team.

Teaching & programmes

55 entries

Programme direction, year tutoring and module leadership across four schools and two decades. Expand a strand to see the modules.

2019 – present

MSc Computing · MSc IT Management

Module leader — Team Software Development Project

2019 – present

BSc Software Engineering · Computing · BIS · Computer Science · Games Development

Module leader — Research Methods

2013 – present

BSc Software Engineering · Computing · Business Information Systems

Module leader — Technology Project Management, Systems Development & Design

2011 – present

MSc Technology Project Management

Module leader & lecturer — Technology Project Management

2008 – 2012

Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)

Module leader — Design for Interaction, User Centred Design, Production Processes, Design for Change

Plus People, Realise, Process and Future (levels 4–6), Modernism in Art & Design, Art & Design after Modernism, Entrepreneurship & Professional Practice, Contemporary & Contextual Studies.

2007 – 2008

Cardiff School of Art & Design — cross-programme teaching

Graphic Communication BA · Fine Art MAP BA · Broadcast Media & Popular Culture BA

Creative Information, Web & Print, Competitions, Real World Projects, New Media, Audition.

2001 – 2007

Business Information Systems & Design for Interactive Media

HNC · HND · BSc · MSc

Multimedia, Commercial Aspects of Multimedia, MSc Human Computer Interaction, Retail Management BA/HND, and the full Design for Interactive Media module set.

Module leadership — Cardiff School of Technologies

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2019 – present	Team Software Development Project MSc Computing · MSc IT Management
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2019 – present	Research Methods BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS · Computer Science · Games Development
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2013 – present	Technology Project Management BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS
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2011 – present	Technology Project Management MSc Technology Project Management
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Module leadership — Cardiff School of Management

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2012 – present	Systems Development & Design BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS
2012 – 2018	E-Business Management BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS
2012 – 2017	Mobile Applications BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS
2013 – 2014	Human Computer Interaction BSc Soft Eng · Computing · BIS
2008 – 2012	Design for Interaction Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)
2008 – 2012	User Centred Design Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)
2008 – 2012	Production Processes Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)
2008 – 2012	Design for Change Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)

Module leadership — Cardiff School of Art & Design

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2005 – 2007	Design for Interaction Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2005 – 2007	User Centred Design Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2005 – 2007	Production Processes Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2005 – 2007	Design for Change Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc

2002 – 2005	Multimedia Business Information Systems BSc · HND · HNC
2003 – 2005	Commercial Aspects of Multimedia Business Information Systems BSc Multimedia
2003 – 2005	Human Computer Interaction Business Information Systems MSc
2002 – 2005	Design for Interaction Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2002 – 2005	User Centred Design Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2002 – 2004	Production Processes Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2002 – 2005	Design for Change Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc
2002 – 2004	Entrepreneurship & Professional Practice Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc

2011 – present	MSc Technology Project Management Cardiff School of Technologies
2012 – present	Systems Development & Design · Technology Project Management Cardiff School of Technologies
2013 – present	BSc Software Engineering · Computing · Business Information Systems Cardiff School of Technologies
2012 – 2018	E-Business Management Cardiff School of Management
2012 – 2015	Systems Programming Cardiff School of Management
2011 – present	Mobile Applications Cardiff School of Management
2011 – 2012	Business Applications BSc Business Information Systems
2013 – 2014	Human Computer Interaction Cardiff School of Management
2008 – 2012	Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons) Cardiff School of Management
2007 – 2008	Audition Broadcast Media & Popular Culture BA — CSAD
2007 – 2008	Creative Information · Web & Print · Competitions · Real World Projects Graphic Communication BA — CSAD
2007 – 2008	New Media Fine Art, MAP, BA — CSAD
2005 – 2007	Full Design for Interactive Media module set, incl. Research Methods & Personal Projects Cardiff School of Art & Design
2005 – 2006	Real World Projects Graphic Communication BA — CSAD
2003 – 2005	Retail Management BA · HND Cardiff School of Business

2001 – 2005 Business Information Systems BSc · HND · HNC (Multimedia)
Cardiff School of Business

2001 – 2005 Full Design for Interactive Media module set
Cardiff School of Business

Programme direction & curriculum design

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2019 Computing for Interaction BSc (Hons) · Computing with Creative Design BSc (Hons)
Cardiff School of Technologies

2011 – 2012 Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)
Cardiff School of Management

2010 – 2012 BSc/HNC Computing & Information Systems (part-time) · Lead Academic, MBA by Distance Learning
Cardiff School of Management

2008 – 2010 Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) and Top-up
Cardiff School of Art & Design

2004 – 2007 Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) and Top-up
Cardiff School of Business

— Wrote the three-year BSc/BA Design for Interactive Media degree up from the Top-up award, with extensive ongoing modification to keep it effective and current.

— Incorporated a wide range of assessment methods into the programme, including peer assessment, formal written reports and presentations.

External examining, moderation & validation

40 entries

Five external examinations, three moderation positions, and validation panel service for UK and overseas awards on 32 occasions — across UK, European, Middle Eastern, North African and South-East Asian partner institutions.

2013 – 2016

External Examiner

Glasgow Caledonian University

MA 3D Design for Virtual Environments; BSc (Hons)/BSc Interactive Media Development; BA (Hons)/BA 3D Animation; BA Computer Games; BSc (Hons) Digital Design; BSc (Hons) Digital Design (3D animation and visualisation).

2014 – 2017

External Examiner

Staffordshire University — Gulf College, Oman

BSc Computing and BSc Software Engineering.

2014 – 2015

External Examiner

University of Ulster

FdA Interactive Design.

2011 – 2014

External Examiner

University of West London

BA (Hons)/Dip HE Games Development and BA (Hons)/Dip HE Digital Media Production.

2012 – 2016

External Moderator — all postgraduate studies

Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport, Egypt

2007 – 2016

External Moderator, Design for Interactive Media HNC & HND

Bridgend College, Glamorgan

An earlier period of moderation for the same awards ran 2003–2005.

2010 – 2012

External Moderator, Graphic Design BA (Hons)

EADE, Málaga, Spain

2002 – present

Conference paper reviewer

BCS Human Computer Interface Group, British Computer Society

2010	MBA (Marketing Management) Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2010	MBA (Human Resources) Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2010	MBA (Project Management) Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2010	MBA (Banking & Finance) Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2010	BA (Hons) Accounting & Finance Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2010	BA (Hons) Marketing Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport — Egypt
2009	International Business Management BA Casablanca & Marrakech, Morocco
2009	MBA Casablanca & Marrakech, Morocco
2009	Tourism Management BA Casablanca & Marrakech, Morocco
2009	Marketing BA Casablanca & Marrakech, Morocco
2008	Business Information Systems BSc Singapore
2008	Banking & Finance BSc Singapore
2008	Accounting BSc Singapore
2008	Computing BSc & Ordinary London School of Commerce, London
2008	Information Technology MSc London School of Commerce, London
2007	Business Studies BA Dhaka, Bangladesh

2007	Business Studies BA Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
2007	Business Studies BA (accreditation) Madrid
2007	Business Information Systems BSc (accreditation) Madrid
2007	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (accreditation) Madrid
2007	Marketing BA (accreditation) Madrid

Validation panels — UWIC / Cardiff Met

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2010	Business Information Systems UWIC, Cardiff
2007	Dance BA UWIC, Cardiff
2006	Psychology BSc UWIC, Cardiff
2006	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) Programme Director
2005	Business Information Systems BSc (Hons) Multimedia Programme Director
2005	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) Top-up Programme Director
2002	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) Top-up Programme member
2001 – 2005	Numerous degree and HND programmes Panellist

Validation events led

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2008	Mobile, Web & Game Design BA/BSc (Hons)
2005	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons)
2001	Design for Interactive Media BA/BSc (Hons) Top-up

Industry & practice

4 entries

1996 – 2019

Managing Director

Deft Design

New media consultancy and production, and the foundation of his understanding of directing a company and managing creative, highly skilled projects and teams. Usability testing for BBC New Media across the Education website, Video Window and Red Button (2005–06); CD-ROM development for Loughborough Students' Union (2001–06); British Institute of Swimming (2004); and many others.

BBC New Media

Loughborough Students' Union

British Institute of Swimming

2000 – 2001

Freelance Project Manager & Multimedia Developer

Kode Digital

Clients included Boomerang Television, 6721 and S4C Television. Work for Boomerang Television won the BAFTA for Best New Media.

Boomerang Television

S4C Television

6721

2000

Creative Director

Marr Corporation

Managed two new media companies: FWebs (SME and micro-company development) and T2 Design (corporate development).

1996 – 2000

TV Production Assistant & Multimedia Developer

WH Communicates

Television production and new media for international organisations and leading UK companies — developing creative solutions to the interactive problems of their trade. This real-world experience ignited a drive to attain the highest standards in design practice.

European Commission

Foreign Office

Intellectual Property Office

British Telecom

Central Office of Information

Highways Agency

Millennium Commission

Docklands Light Railway

Scottish Power

Dŵr Cymru Welsh Water

East of Scotland Water

SWALEC

SWEB

Hyder

Gwent Police

GEC Marconi

General Electric

Rockwool

Amec

Elf Oil

Gwent TEC

Awards & judging

6 entries

2000

BAFTA — Best New Media

Boomerang Television, via Kode Digital

1998

Editing for Industry Awards — Best Internal Communications Video in the UK

Client: Hyder

1998

British Association of Communicators in Business — Electronic Publications, Internal category

Client: Hyder

2007

Judge — BAFTA Cymru, New Media

Award panellist

2006

Judge — Celtic Film Festival, New Media

Award panellist

2004 & 2006

Judge — Golden Pixel Awards

Award panellist, two panels

Art exhibitions

7 entries

Exhibited work in the UK and the Netherlands, 1991–1996.

1996

Corridors

University of Wales College, Newport, UK

13–29 May.

1995

Biometrics

Newport Leisure Centre, Kingsway, UK

22 May.

1994

Karmel Convent

Boxmeer / Nijmegen, Netherlands

22 September – 15 October.

1994

Lorentz School

Hilversum, Netherlands

5–30 September.

1994

Bookshop Veenendaal

Amersfoort, Netherlands

17–31 March.

1994

Broadcasting Museum

Hilversum, Netherlands

5 February – 29 April.

1991

Playhouse

Harlow, Essex, UK

25 June.

Research, funding & enterprise

15 entries

Current

Contemporary issues in software engineering management

Doctoral research, Cardiff Metropolitan University

Earlier

Education and emergent urban art

Earlier area of research interest

Member

MeAT Research Group

Metaphysics : Embodiment : Aesthetics : Technology

Part of the Design Enhanced Human Futures (DEHF) group within the Wales Institute for Research in Art and Design (WIRAD).

Research & enterprise projects

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Jan 2009	MeAT Research With Dr Stephen Thompson, Dr Ashley Morgan, Theo Humphries, Chris Glynn, Jon Pigott, Fakri Othman and Ina Pruegel
Dec 2009	Pedestrian — further development of the Tutoritool Extending the tool into new environments that embrace physicality
May 2009	WIRAD Paper submission
Dec 2009	Saul Helan (Reverse SIP) Tutoring to give Music Technology & Production students hands-on experience of broadcasting their final-year productions online
Sep 2008	Rhondda Cynon Taf Arts KTP application supervision

Externally funded projects (since 2003)

7

2005 – 2008	Creative Partnership, Leicester — Creative Curriculum Ashfield School
2005 – 2008	Creative Partnership, Coventry — Creative Curriculum Pearlhyde School
2005 – 2006	History of Leicester Music Heritage Fund / Leicestershire Constabulary
2005	Turntable Radio, Remix Bristol & Bath Youth Music Action Zone, The Watershed
2005	PAYP — Positive Activities for Young People (Northampton, Leicester, Lincoln) Connexions
2004 – 2007	Below the Waterline Arts Council England, east midlands music promoters, regional music development agencies, GOEM, Prince's Trust
2003 – 2004	Tutoritool Arts Council England / Pedestrian

2020 – 2026

Doctoral Degree (PhD)

Cardiff Metropolitan University

Investigating contemporary issues within software engineering management. Submission September 2026.

2012

Postgraduate Certificate — Applied Social Research

Cardiff Metropolitan University

With postgraduate Research Methods and Ethics training the same year.

1993 – 1996

BA (Hons) Interactive Arts

University of Wales, Newport

Specialisms in telemedia, sound installation art, media theory & history, and site-specific art.

Continuing professional development

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2012	Postgraduate Research Methods — Ethics Training
2009	Interview Panel Training
2009	EAP Training
2009	NOCN Training
2008	Missenden emergent researchers training
2008	Work Stress — A Manager's Role
2007	Blackboard: Podcasting in Learning & Teaching
2007	Using Wikis and Blogs — Blackboard
2006	SharePoint Training
2005	Advanced Virtual Learning Environment Development
2005	Disability & Advice Training
2004	Virtual Learning Environment Development

MBCS	Professional Member, British Computer Society Ten years and more
BCS	Member, British Computer Society Human Computer Interface Group
ACM	Member, Association for Computing Machinery — Special Interest Group
MIEEE	Member, Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers
FRSA	Fellow, Royal Society for the encouragement of Arts, Manufactures & Commerce
FHEA	Fellow, Higher Education Academy Cardiff Met SFHEA training completed; case-study evidence in preparation
MeAT	Member, MeAT Research Group — DEHF / WIRAD

University & school committees

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Ongoing	School Management & Planning Team (SMPT) Active member; experience of chairing school committee meetings
Ongoing	Collaborative Provision Committee Cardiff Metropolitan University
2007 – 2012	E-Learning Process Management Group Cardiff School of Art & Design
2007 – 2012	LIS IT Security Group Cardiff School of Art & Design
2005 – 2010	UWIC Wireless Network Committee Cardiff School of Art & Design
2005 – 2010	Learning & Teaching Committee Cardiff School of Art & Design
2005 – 2010	Computers in Art & Design Committee Cardiff School of Art & Design
2002 – 2005	Computers in Art & Design Committee Cardiff School of Business
2001 – 2005	Computing Department Discipline Group Cardiff School of Business
2001 – 2005	Business Information Systems Committee Cardiff School of Business
2001 – 2005	Learning & Teaching Committee UWIC Business School

2010 – 2014	Trustee Pedestrian Arts, National Charity
2007 – 2014	Education Director Pedestrian Arts Limited
2008 – 2012	Board Director Bulb Roots, a non-profit Arts Organisation
1997 – 2007	Pedestrian, a non-profit National Arts Organisation Founding member
2002 – 2007	Pedestrian, Vice-Chairman
2002 – 2014	Tutor
1997 – Present	Artist

The good bits

“This working stuff is really cool”

Career moments, in Stuart's own words

- ★ A helicopter shoot at 250 ft above Tower Bridge with the sun flaring over the spires of London's skyline.
- ★ Having the corporate marketing tech team at BT in London stand around my work and ask “How did you do that?”
- ★ Winning a BAFTA for Best New Media, when I had no idea I was even entered.
- ★ Being involved with the excitement and passion of students researching and developing creative and inspirational work.
- ★ Onstage at Hackney Marshes with Ice-T, Mark B & Blade, Biz Markie and Rodney P.
- ★ Watching a young person who had been expelled from school, and excluded for the best part of his formative years, get his first qualification without realising it.

Get in touch

Please don't hesitate to drop me a line if you would like to explore any area of this work in greater detail, see evidence and examples, or take up formal references.

smcneil@cardiffmet.ac.uk · 02920 417176 · Department of Software Engineering, Cardiff School of Technologies, Cardiff Metropolitan University, Llandaff, Cardiff CF5 2YB

www.stuartmcneil.co (<https://www.stuartmcneil.co>) · stuartmcneil.github.io/window (<https://stuartmcneil.github.io/window>) ·

www.cardiffmet.ac.uk (<https://www.cardiffmet.ac.uk>)

Representation: Professor Jon Platts, Dean of Cardiff School of Technologies — jplatts@cardiffmet.ac.uk · 02920 417000